Sri Lanka
MUSLIM CHORAL ENSEMBLE

OUR STORY

The Journey....



"I BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PERFORMING ARTS TO REACH OUT AND COMMUNICATE TO HEARTS AND MINDS" ~

Haadia Galely, Co-Founder and Executive Director of MCE

muslimchoralensemble.com

/muslimchoralensemble

/mce_srilanka/

BIRTH OF A VISION - *FOR LOVE & HUMANITY*



MUSLIM CHORAL ENSEMBLE 2017 - Ambassadors of Peace

The Muslim Choral Ensemble (MCE) co-founded in August 2017, by Haadia Galely (Executive Director), Professor André de Quadros (Artistic Director) and supported by vocal coach Manoj Sanjeewa, is the only such of its nature globally, based in the city of Colombo. Inspired by spiritual recitation practiced through the ages in the Islamic World, this vision was born. This initiative is aimed at creating a platform for Muslim Singers to present Islamic Spiritual repertoire and form an inclusive male and female choir embracing the various Muslim and non-Muslim communities. (both national and international)The purpose of this undertaking is to reach out and spread a message of peace and harmony, through performing works from a rich global Islamic heritage, and innovate on traditional oral work with modern techniques and compositions. Diversity is to be celebrated through a repertoire consisting of Islamic spirituals that include Zikr, Nashīds, Qasidas, and Qawwali in various languages.

BIRTH OF A VISION - *FOR LOVE & HUMANITY*



The Muslim Choral Ensemble is aligned to the performing arts through the genre of Islamic spiritual renditions. The first Sama International Choral Festival 2023 took place from 24 to 30 July 2023 under the auspices of the Muslim Choral Ensemble. This residency, a collaboration of local and international artists, took place in Sri Lanka and included a series of performances, events, and opportunities to engage through culture-sharing and collective music-making sessions. This was a bold next step in bringing together Muslims and non-Muslims to engage in various unique choral traditions from around the world and breathe new life into this genre of choral music.



OUR VISION: To foster a world where Islamic spirituals will resonate globally, transcending borders and cultural divides, uniting hearts in a chorus of peace, understanding, and solidarity. The Muslim Choral Ensemble, with its unique role in celebrating and safeguarding the richness of Muslim culture and history, aspires to create pathways towards promoting unity. Our vision is a world where voices join in harmony, echoing the values of love, compassion, and respect, creating a symphony of cultural integration and mutual respect.

OUR MISSION is to perform songs from the Muslim World, while training, and performing at the highest artistic level, through fostering individual development, collaboration and intercultural relationships.

LEADERSHIP



Haadia Galely

Co-founder | Executive Director



Professor Andre de Quadros

Co-Founder | Artistic Director



Manoj Sanjeewa

Associate Artistic Director | Vocal Coach

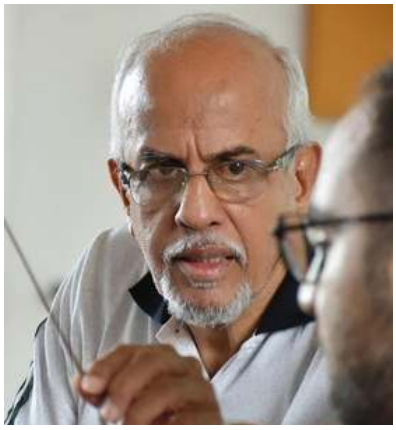
THE BOARD OF TRUSTEES

mce Sri Lanka

MUSLIM CHORAL ENSEMBLE FOUNDATION TRUST
TRUST DEED NO 911
SINCE 2023



Haadia Shabbir Galely



Shabbir Ebrahim Galely



Sajeda Akbarally



Nafeesa Khozema Amiruddeen



Ahmed Areeb Huzair

FOUNDER
Haadia Shabbir Galely

BOARD OF TRUSTEES
Haadia Shabbir Galely, Sajeda Akbarally, Shabbir Ebrahim Galely, Ahmad Areeb Huzair, Nafeesa Khozema Amirudden

Sky Gardens Apartment # 11 B 39, Perera Mawatte, Kotuwegoda Rajagiriya, Sri Lanka

muslimchoralensemble@gmail.com www.muslimchoralensemble.com
+94 777 369 400

IMRA AWARDS 2024





Award

Haadia Galely was recognized for her pioneering work at the IMRA Awards 2024.

She founded the first Muslim Choral Ensemble in 2017, followed by the World Muslim Choral Ensemble in 2022. Her dedication to promoting unity and diversity has been a source of inspiration, and her team is proud to stand alongside her.

Haadia was honored with the Award of Excellence in the Art & Culture category at a prestigious ceremony held at the Lotus Ballroom of the Shangri-La Hotel. In her acceptance speech, she highlighted how Islamic Spirituals have bridged cultural divides and fostered understanding and respect for others.

This recognition underscores the potential for positive change and the importance of celebrating our unique differences by coming together.

LETTER OF APPRECIATION

Sri Lanka
MUSLIM CHORAL ENSEMBLE

Dearest Shabba, Alifiya, and Hussain, This is a heartfelt validation of how my faith has helped me through many phases of my life. Through triumph and trial, faith has been my steadfast guide, and the unwavering support of the three of you reinforced further that strength and resolve in me.

My deepest gratitude to my husband, Shabbir; words cannot fully sum up my appreciation for your support. You have been the quiet force, patiently supporting everything I set out to do. I remain grateful to you for providing the stability that has allowed me to pursue my dreams.

Alifiya and Hussain, my children, you both have been my pillars of strength. Your love and support have meant the world to me, especially during the most challenging times. The compassion and caring nature you both possess have always brought me comfort. Your belief in me has inspired me to keep pushing forward, no matter
the obstacles. You have shouldered my ups and downs with grace and understanding, and I am profoundly blessed for that.

My wish and prayer for all families is that you commit to experiencing the profound bonds between family and friends that will become your greatest possessions. By that, I mean the love, unity, mutual support, and understanding you nurture and share, will become your constant source of motivation and joy.

Thank you, Shabba, Alifiya, and Hussain, for loving and supporting
me unconditionally.

With Love and Gratitude
Your Wife | Your Mother

Sky Gardens Apartment # 11 B 39, Perera Mawatte, Kotuwegoda Rajagiriya, Sri Lanka
+94 777 369 400
muslimchoralensemble@gmail.com
www.muslimchoralensemble.com

AN 'NUR - THE LIGHT
2ND JUNE 2024
LIONEL WENDT THEATRE

An-Nur
Heart Strings Unite



The Muslim Choral Ensemble (MCE) extends heartfelt gratitude for the invaluable support received towards "An-Nur 2024," a presentation held on the 2nd of June 2024, at the Lionel Wendt Theatre in Colombo.

The evening was a success, Alhumdulillah, due to the generosity and unwavering support, transforming the initiative into a meaningful platform for fostering communal harmony. Through this platform, they have engaged with members from various faith traditions, raising awareness and paving the way for mutual dialogue and respect.

The support received has been crucial in achieving the vision of inclusivity and diversity. Profound gratitude is extended to those who have joined the mission of the Muslim Choral Ensemble.

Sincere thanks go to:

- Patron: Mr. Hanif Yusuf
- Haadia Galely: Founder for her visionary guidance and dedication to the Muslim Choral Ensemble.
- Manoj: For his invaluable support as Vocal Coach and Associate Artistic Director.
- Murthaaz Barry: Assisting Vocal Coach.
- Core Working Committee: Nafeesa, Aqeela, Sajeda, Aflal, Banine, Arafa, Zahra for diligently working behind the scenes.
- Sound Engineers: Kishan Perera of Unicsounds and Crew headed by Ranga for their exceptional work and unconditional support.
- Akry: For his expertise in lighting and stage management.
- Staff of Lionel Wendt: For their dedicated support and service behind the scenes.
- The management of Paan Paan - our culinary partners

Thank you to all our sponsors and supporters for their invaluable contributions in making "An-Nur 2024" a truly memorable event.

Huzaifa H Abdulhussein

Star Packaging (Pvt) Ltd.

Yusuf Karim

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AN 'NUR - THE LIGHT

Continued....





Special Appreciation: To Vihanga for his memorable guest spot in the opening and closing acts.

Members of the Muslim Choral Ensemble: For their participation and commitment

The Ummu Zaviya and the Panchikawatte Zaviya the two oldest Zaviyas were represented by their respective Madrasa students led by the Khalifathus Shazuli Al Ustaz M.S..M. Ahmed Sufi (Mahlari) & assisted by Moulavi M. Nasri (Bahji) and coordinated by Haji Mohamed Bashim Muhsin President of Panchikawatte Zaviya.

Imran, Sajeda, and Murthaaz: For their flawless coordination and presentation on stage as presenters throughout the evening.









MINARETS - A Documentary featuring Muslim Choral Ensemble

Photo credits Nadya Perera,Darshani Rathnayake Kaushalya Nandasena Pravin Wijesinghe)



A conversation on cultural politics, music, sanctioned sound art and the Muslims of Sri Lanka

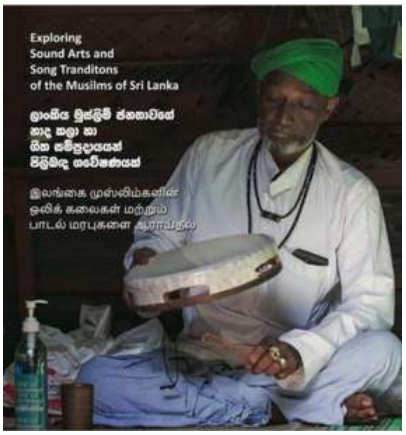
Documentary by Nadya Bhimani Perera

Minarets















MUSLIM CHORAL ENSEMBLE 2024

Sama International Choral Festival (10 day residency) July 2023









The Sama International Choral Festival brought together both local and international artists in Sri Lanka in July 2023. This curated a series of performances, events, and opportunities to engage and collaborate through culture-sharing and creative music-making sessions.





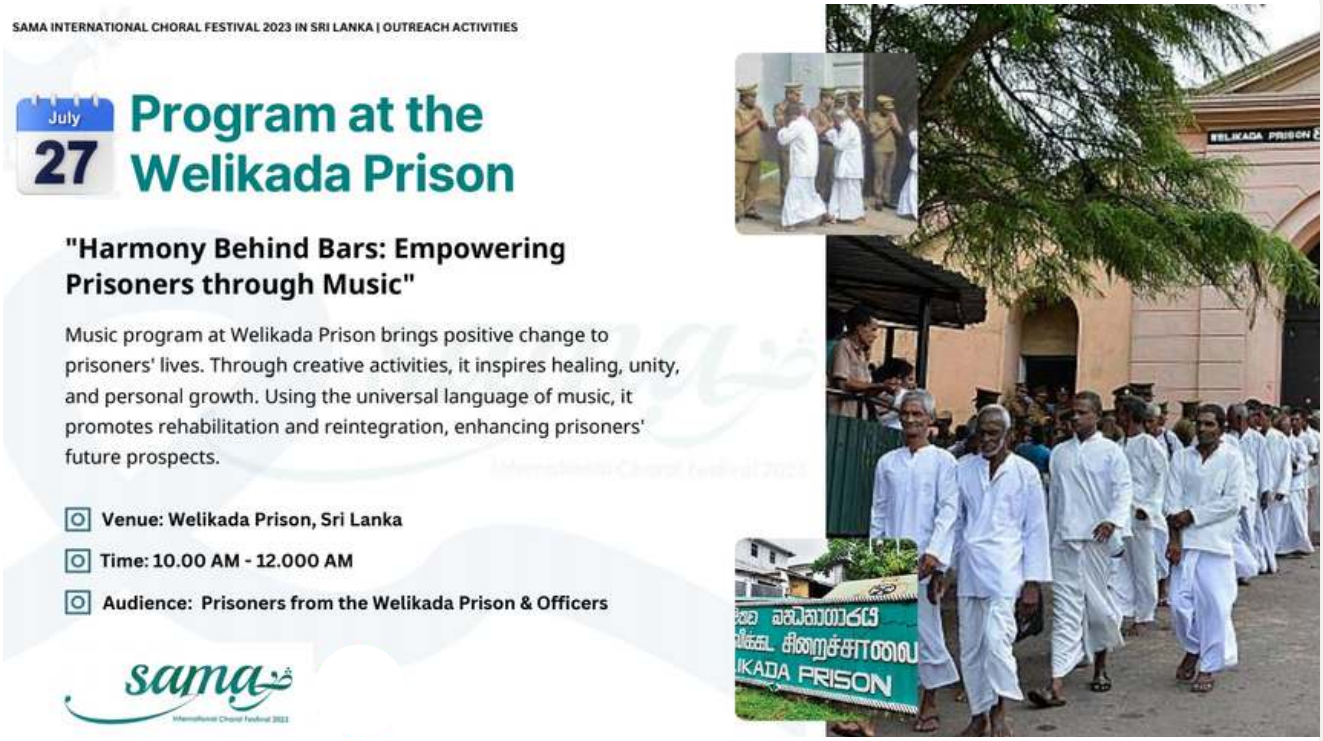






OUTREACH PROGRAMMES





OUTREACH PROGRAMMES

SAMA INTERNATIONAL CHORAL FESTIVAL 2023 IN SRI LANKA | OUTREACH ACTIVITIES

July 27

Minarets Documentary

Screening and Open Discussion of "Minarets: the Music of the Muslims"

This is an open discussion of Nadya Bhimani Perera's documentary film "Minarets," about the Music of Muslims in Sri Lanka. The discussion will be moderated by Eshantha Peiris.

- Venue: PVR Cinema: One Galle Face Mall
- Time: 6.00 PM
- Audience: 120 Seats | Invitees & Limited public reservations



SAMA INTERNATIONAL CHORAL FESTIVAL 2023 IN SRI LANKA | OUTREACH ACTIVITIES

July 28

Program at Ratmalana Blind School

Melody of Possibilities: Uniting Hearts, Embracing the Gift of Music

Inspiring workshop, where our musicians and choir members come together to uplift and connect with the students. Through the universal language of music, we aim to break barriers and connect with the extraordinary individuals at the school. Through interactive sessions, we will explore the transformative power of melodies, rhythms, and harmonies, allowing the students to feel the vibrations and experience the joy of music.

- Venue: Blind School, Rathmalana.
- Time: 3.00 PM - 5.00 PM
- Audience: Students from the Blind School in Sri Lanka



OUTREACH PROGRAMMES

July 26

Music Workshop at Wesley College

Peaceful Rhythms Uniting the World

A workshop where voices from around the world unite to inspire harmony. Through interactive sessions, choir members from diverse backgrounds connect with school students, fostering cultural exchange and understanding in advocating peace.

- Venue: Wesley College
- Time: 3.00 PM
- Audience: Students from Wesley College & Lyceum International School



July 29

Forum at Lakshman Kadirgamar Institute

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- Venue: LKI Colombo
- Time: 2.00 PM
- Audience: 120 Seats | Invitees & Limited public reservations





Inaugration of the "World Muslim Choral Ensemble" July 2022

WORLD MUSLIM CHORAL ENSEMBLE







Voices for Peace was presented to commemorate the tragedy of The Easter Sunday 2019.
The interfaith choir was launched in 2022 to set in motion a reconciliation process to overcome the religious divides.

















Voices for Peace 2
Interfaith Choral Collaboration in partnership with Shangri-La
February 2022

Shangri-La hotel
COLOMBO



















Maker Majlis - March 2021
A presentations for the Hamqd Bin Khalifa University Qatar under the auspices of the Qatar Foundation

MAKER MAJLIS
ميكر مجلس
DESIGN POST-COVID HUMANITY
تصميم إنسانية ما بعد كوفيد-١٩
TAARUF · TAAWUN · TARAHUM تعارف · تعاون · تراحم

جامعة حمد بن خليفة
HAMAD BIN KHALIFA UNIVERSITY
عضو في مؤسسة قطر
Member of Qatar Foundation









MACFEST - December 2021

MACFEST
MUSLIM ARTS AND CULTURE FESTIVAL





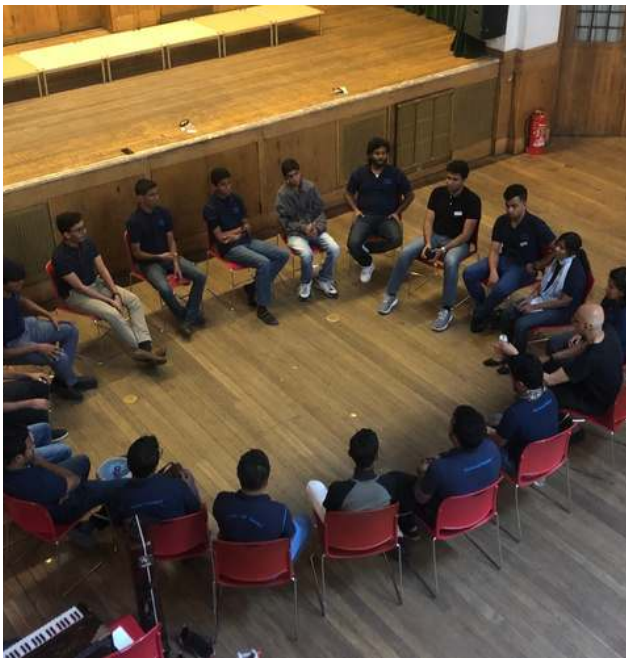


Participated at
London International Music Festival
July 2019





















Voices for Peace - Interfaith Choral Collaboration in partnership with Shangri-La Colombo July 2019

Shangri-La hotel
COLOMBO





Voices for Peace was presented to commemorate the tragedy of The Easter Sunday 2019. The interfaith choir was launched in 2022 to set in motion a reconciliation process to overcome the religious divides.

Performance Contributed to "Dhow foundation" Esufally Family Foundation) August2018

DHOW
FOUNDATION









Invited to the Yale International Choral Festival - June 2018

Yale International Choral Festival















Muslim Choral Ensemble presentation at Russian Cultural Centre Jan 2018



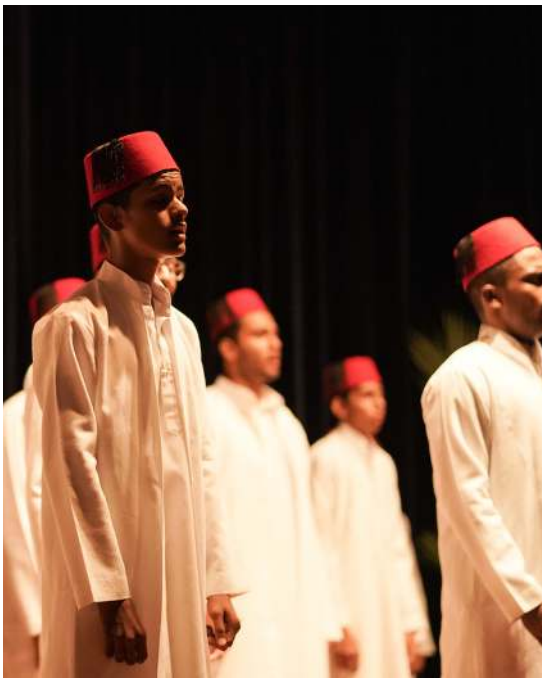






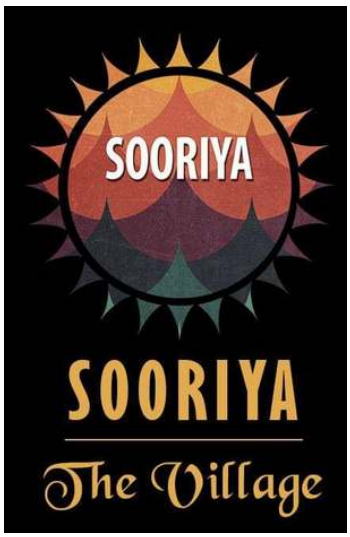






Launch of the Muslim Choral Ensemble August - 2017









Russian Cultural Center and Sooriya Village August 2017











HEARTFELT GRATITUDE FOR ENRICHING OUR JOURNEY



Hanif Yusoof
OUR PATRON



Soundarie David Rodrigo

Artistic Directors
Voices for Peace



Francis D' Almeida



Shahid Shabaz

Special appreciation goes to Shahid Shabaz for standing by MCE since 2017 while sharing his expertise, with the group in Sufi music



Alireza Shahini
DUFF Player - WMCE

A Special word of gratitude to Alireza Shahini, a skilled percussionist and Duff player, has brought a vibrant energy to our presentations through his collaborations with MCE



Our Musicians

We would like to acknowledge the valuable contributions of our sessional musicians, Sasanka Rajasekara, Shammika Mohotti, and Dinanjana Madushanka, for their support.



GUEST CHOIRS



VOICES 21C

an artist collective, passionately utilizes choral art to advocate for human rights and global understanding through music. Collaborating with the Muslim Choral Ensemble, they have aimed to sensitize social concerns by exchanging narratives, repertoire, and cultural insights to help unite communities. They stand out as one of the few choirs engaging deeply with singers from diverse backgrounds, fostering global cultural equity through music.

The Manado State University Choir (MSUC)

The Manado State University Choir (MSUC) from Indonesia boasts a versatile repertoire from early to contemporary Western and Southeast Asian music. Under Professor André de Quadros' direction, MSUC has garnered acclaim internationally, weaving together diverse cultural and religious influences. MSUC aims to foster peace and cultural flourishing worldwide by embracing love and spirituality.



HEARTFELT GRATITUDE

- To our Parents, we owe our unwavering love and gratitude.
- Our Patron Mr. Hanif Yusoof, our heartfelt gratitude for all the moral support over the years
- Prof. André de Quadros, our Artistic Director, thank you for believing and supporting the vision.
- Vocal Coach Manoj Sanjeewa, We are grateful to you for your training and for standing by us and guiding MCE to achieve our goals
- Jeffery Douma for always being so encouraging.
- Jeremy Haneman for your moral support and more recently, referring to us as 'Unique" was gratifying.
- Trey for your unwavering support from inception and during our visit to YALE

OUR MEDIA PARTNERS

We sincerely appreciate the media members,

- Ms Daleena Samara - Independent Journalist
- Mrs. Fahima Farisz - Ceylon Today
- Mr Ishara Jayawardene - Daily News
- Mr Nishtar Cassim - Wijaya Newspapers
- Ms. Renuka Sadanandan - Sunday Times
- Mr. Janeeth Rodrigo - PULSE

Camera crew and Journalists of all publications played an integral role in capturing and sharing "Our Journey" THANK YOU!

A Heartfelt Thank You:

Shabbir Galely- Printing
Dr.Shabbir Akberally - Venue Partner
Mohammed Adamally – Legal Guidance
Aboo Yusoof- Hospitality
Unique Sounds, Kishan Perera, Ranga, and the entire team for their expert technical support

HEARTFELT GRATITUDE

The Muslim Choral Ensemble- Board of Trustees consisting of:
Haadia Galely, Nafeesa Amirudeen, Sajeda Akbarally
Shabir Ebrahim Galely and Areeb Huzair

Our Venue partners

- Shangri-La hotel
- 80 Club
- Akbar Brothers Auditorium
- Ishq Colombo

- Special appreciation to Ashan Perera for overseeing all the outreach activites for the Sama International Choral Festival 2023.
- Yazmin Yusuf, our partner for seven years, words cannot express my gratitude for your continuous presence and support on this journey.
- Dr Shabbir and family, for graciously opening the doors of Sakviti Lane to us every Wednesday, providing a nurturing space where MCE feels truly at home.

The resource Team

- Nafeesa Amiruddeen
- Aflal Anver
- Aisha Imshan
- Hafeel Farisz
- Murthaaz Barry
- Mohamed Ziyad
- Shameem AbdulRahman
- Zara Raheem
- Sajeda Akbarally
- Ummulbanin Caderbhoy
- Aqeela Yusoof

HEARTFELT GRATITUDE

World Muslim Choral Ensemble members:

- Adnan Manzoor (India)
- Basit Fazli (India)
- Brad Dumont (USA)
- Farzad Omidi (Iran)
- Navid Eskandari Delfan (Iran)
- Krystal Morin (USA)
- Mahgol Safdari (Iran)
- Iman Shahid (Pakistan)
- Nabeel Sarangi (India)

A special mention is due to the past members who have contributed to this journey:

- Maryam Wadood
- Nidaal Suby
- Amaan Fawzul Haq
- Amaan Refai
- Shan Hassim
- Benazir Rizvi
- Hussain Yusoof
- Feros Shanfar
- Shabbeer Abdulrahman
- Shizan Raees

Special thanks is due to our well wishers who have contributed to this journey:

Hussain Galely, Alifiya Naji, Sajeda Akbarally, Farida Akbarally, Khozema Amiruddeen, Fatima Chopra, Sajjad Mowzoon, Abdul Karim Yoosuf & Yusuf Karim (MidcityMarketing) Rizwan Shahabdeen (Managing Director of SifaniJewellers), Zuraish Hashim, Saema Lokandwala, Ikram Mohamed, Ashroff Omar(BRANDIX), Muslim Commercial Bank, Mustafa Abidali of Ceylon Artisans and Harin Udeshi (Udeshi Trust)

Our heartfelt gratitude is extended for every contribution made, that has helped ease the responsibilities towards achieving our goals. As we continue our mission, we thank you for sharing this vision with us

LETTERS OF RECOMMENDATION

Yale SCHOOL OF MUSIC

P.O. Box 208246 New Haven, CT 06520-8246 T 203 432-1965 F 203 432-7542

8 August, 2022

courier

Abby and Mitch Leigh Hall
435 College Street
New Haven CT 06511

To whom it may concern:

It is a pleasure to have this opportunity to offer my enthusiastic recommendation on behalf of the Muslim Choral Ensemble from Sri Lanka, who wish to participate at the World Symposium on Choral Music 2023 that is scheduled to take place in Istanbul, Turkey, 25-30 April 2023

My association with MCE began in June 2018 when Yale Glee Club hosted the third Yale International Choral Festival, an event produced in collaboration with the Yale School of Music, the International Festival of Arts & Ideas, and the Yale Alumni Chorus, continuing an exciting new chapter in Yale University's long tradition of international choral exchange. MCE participated in several days of workshops, rehearsals, and concerts, and their presence at the festival was inspiring to audiences and participants alike.

Since this initial collaboration, I have followed the progress that MCE has made and am happy to say they have demonstrated consistency in their growth and progress toward their goal of harnessing the power of choral singing to promote peace and understanding across national, religious, and ethnic boundaries. Their successful launch this summer of the World Muslim Choral Ensemble, comprising musicians from India, Iran, Pakistan, the USA and Sri Lanka, was yet another key event in their journey.

MCE's presence at the World Symposium would not only share a rich choral tradition not widely known to many symposium attendees but would also provide a transformative example of the ways in which choral singing can make a difference in our world. Please feel free to contact me if I can offer more information about them and their work.

Yours sincerely,



Dr. Jeffrey Douma
Professor of Choral Conducting
Yale School of Music
203.376.8258
jeffrey.douma@yale.edu

LETTERS OF RECOMMENDATION

Boston University College of Fine Arts
School of Music

855 Commonwealth Avenue
Boston, Massachusetts 02215
T 617-353-3341
www.bu.edu/cfa

April 16, 2016 To Whom It May Concern:

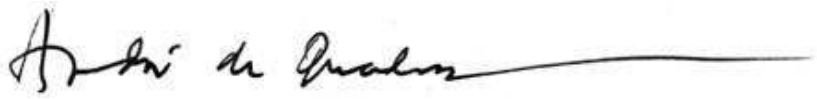
I write in support of Ms Haadia Galely's concept to create a festival that will attract a wide sector of the Sri Lankan community.

Festivals are commonplace in most countries, and the festival proposed by Ms Galely will influence local talented musicians by bringing them into contact with international musicians. Additionally, the festival will undoubtedly have enormous impact on Sri Lankan education and the development of amateur and professional cultural life. Furthermore, as with all such events, the tourism value is always considerable.

As artistic director of four major international festivals, I understand what is required for the successful operation of a festival. In that regard, I feel confident that an event with Ms Galely at the helm is certainly bound for success. For that reason, I have willingly agreed to serve as an advisor to this event.

I give this proposed event my enthusiastic endorsement.

Yours faithfully



Dr André de Quadros
Professor of Music and Chair, Music Education Department
Affiliate faculty, African Studies Center, Center for the Study of Asia, Institute for the Study of Muslim Societies and Civilizations, Prison Education Program
--
Director, School of Music (2002-2009)
Artistic Director, Boston University Tanglewood Institute (2002-2009)
Chair, Department of Music Education (2001-2005)
Chair, Department of Music, College of Arts and Sciences and Graduate School of Arts and Sciences (2003-2009)
Boston University
mailto:adq@bu.edu
http://www.andredequadros.com

LETTERS OF RECOMMENDATION



Jeremy Haneman
Co-Director, Together Productions CIC

12th August 2022

Reference request from: Haadia Galely
Co-Founder - Executive Director Muslim Choral Ensemble
World Muslin Choral Ensemble, Founder | Executive Director
World Interfaith Choral Ensemble

FAO: IFCM WSCM2023

It is with great pleasure that I provide this reference for the Muslim Choral Ensemble, a unique and extraordinary choir.

I first met this wonderful choir when I was introduced to them by my friend and colleague Professor André de Quadros who I have known and worked with for many years. Together, we organised for the Muslim Choral Ensemble to do a joint concert with one of my own choirs, the Mixed Up Chorus when they came to London in 2019 as part of their performance at the London International Music Festival.

The performances of the Muslim Choral Ensemble were really spellbinding – beautiful and impassioned singing, devout and crystal clear in its intent and balancing improvisation with sacred scripture and collaboration. The choir are unique in their repertoire and approach, bringing to the world music that is seldom heard outside of Islamic religious settings and sung in a variety of languages and with minimal accompaniment. They are pioneers of this genre and are challenging preconceptions both in their own country of Sri Lanka and around the world.

The choir also has an important mission to educate, inform and inspire the world as to the richness and diversity of Islamic music, and to break down barriers of prejudice and stereotyping which are sadly all too common.

I have no hesitation in recommending this amazing and important choir to perform at the WSCM 2023. I feel they will provide a rare opportunity to hear music and experience a culture that is otherwise inaccessible to most of us. Do let me know should you require any further information.

Best wishes

Jeremy Haneman

Jeremy Haneman BMusEd MMus (Cantab) FRSA
Co-Director Together Productions, Community Chorus Director, Royal Opera House Covent Garden 2011-2020
https://jeremyhaneman.com/
jeremy@jhaneman.com